

SPANISH VERB CONJUGATIONS - PODER (TO BE ABLE TO / CAN)

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PRESENT SIMPLE ⚠ Stem Change (o→ue): Presente*

Yo **puedo** - I can / I am able to

Tú **puedes** - You can

Él/Ella **puede** - He/She can

Nosotros **podemos** - We can

Vosotros **podéis** - You all can (Spain)

Ellos **pueden** - They can

PAST SIMPLE (Preterite) ⚠ Irregular Stem: Pretérito Perfecto

Yo **pude** - I could / I managed to

Tú **podiste** - You could

Él/Ella **pudo** - He/She could

Nosotros **podimos** - We could

Vosotros **podisteis** - You all could (Spain)

Ellos **podieron** - They could

FUTURE SIMPLE ⚠ Irregular Stem: Futuro

Yo **podré** - I will be able to

Tú **podrás** - You will be able to

Él/Ella **podrá** - He/She will be able to

Nosotros **podremos** - We will be able to

Vosotros **podréis** - You all will be able to (Spain)

Ellos **podrán** - They will be able to

PRESENT CONTINUOUS ⚠️ **Stem Change (o→u)**: Presente Continuo / Presente Progresivo

Yo **estoy pudiendo** - I am being able to (rare)

Tú **estás pudiendo** - You are being able to

Él/Ella **está pudiendo** - He/She is being able to

Nosotros **estamos pudiendo** - We are being able to

Vosotros **estáis pudiendo** - You all are being able to (Spain)

Ellos **están pudiendo** - They are being able to

⚠️ ****Note****: *Poder* is rarely used in continuous forms. Use simple present instead:
Puedo hacerlo (NOT ~~Estoy pudiendo hacerlo~~).

PAST CONTINUOUS ⚠️ **Rare Usage**:- Pretérito Imperfecto Continuo

Yo **estaba pudiendo** - I was being able to (rare)

Tú **estabas pudiendo** - You were being able to

Él/Ella **estaba pudiendo** - He/She was being able to

Nosotros **estábamos pudiendo** - We were being able to

Vosotros **estabais pudiendo** - You all were being able to (Spain)

Ellos **estaban pudiendo** - They were being able to

FUTURE CONTINUOUS ⚠️ **Rare Usage**:- futuro continuo/progresivo

Yo **estaré pudiendo** - I will be being able to (rare)

Tú **estarás pudiendo** - You will be being able to

Él/Ella **estará pudiendo** - He/She will be being able to

Nosotros **estaremos pudiendo** - We will be being able to

Vosotros **estaréis pudiendo** - You all will be being able to (Spain)

Ellos **estarán pudiendo** - They will be being able to

PRESENT PERFECT:- Pretérito Perfecto Compuesto

Yo **he podido** - I have been able to

Tú **has podido** - You have been able to

Él/Ella ha podido - He/She has been able to

Nosotros hemos podido - We have been able to

Vosotros habéis podido - You all have been able to (Spain)

Ellos han podido - They have been able to

PAST PERFECT:- Pretérito Pluscuamperfecto

Yo **había podido** - I had been able to

Tú **habías podido** - You had been able to

Él/Ella había podido - He/She had been able to

Nosotros habíamos podido - We had been able to

Vosotros habíais podido - You all had been able to (Spain)

Ellos habían podido - They had been able to

FUTURE PERFECT:--- Futuro Perfecto

Yo **habré podido** - I will have been able to

Tú habrás podido - You will have been able to

Él/Ella habrá podido - He/She will have been able to

Nosotros habremos podido - We will have been able to

Vosotros habréis podido - You all will have been able to (Spain)

Ellos habrán podido - They will have been able to

CONDITIONAL ⚠ Irregular Stem:

Yo **podría** - I could / I would be able to

Tú **podrías** - You could

Él/Ella **podría** - He/She could

Nosotros **podríamos** - We could

Vosotros **podríais** - You all could (Spain)

Ellos **podrían** - They could

COULD (CONDITIONAL TENSE):-- CONDITIONAL

⚠ ****Note****: The Conditional tense *is* the "could" form for **poder**.

Yo **podría** + infinitivo - I could + verb

Tú **podrías** + infinitivo - You could + verb

(Example: Podría ayudarte = I could help you)

SHOULD BE ABLE (DEBER + PODER):-- CONDITIONAL

Yo **debería poder** - I should be able to

Tú **deberías poder** - You should be able to

Él/Ella **debería poder** - He/She should be able to

Nosotros **deberíamos poder** - We should be able to

Vosotros **deberíais poder** - You all should be able to (Spain)

Ellos **deberían poder** - They should be able to

EXAMPLE SENTENCES:

- Podría ayudarte con la tarea si tengo tiempo.

(I could help you with the homework if I have time.)

- Debería poder terminar esto para mañana.

(I should be able to finish this by tomorrow.)

- No pude abrir la puerta ayer. (I couldn't open the door yesterday.)

⚠️ ****Important Notes on "Poder"**:**

◆ ****Highly Irregular Verb — Multiple Patterns**:**

Poder is one of the most irregular and important verbs in Spanish.

Tense	Irregularity	Example
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Present	o→ue stem change	*puedo, puedes, puede, pueden*
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Preterite	Irregular stem *pud-*	*pude, pudiste, pudo, pudieron*
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Future/Conditional	Irregular stem *podr-*	*podré, podría*
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Gerund	o→u stem change	*pudiendo* (NOT ~~podiendo~~)
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Present Subjunctive	Based on *yo puedo*	*pueda, puedas, pueda...*
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! ****Critical Preterite Note**:**

Poder in the preterite often implies ****success or failure**** (managed to / failed to):

- ***Pude hacerlo.*** = I managed to do it (and succeeded).

- ***No pude hacerlo.*** = I tried but failed to do it.

◆ ****Key Distinction: Preterite vs. Imperfect**:**

| Tense | Meaning | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| ****Imperfect (*podía*)**** | General ability in past | *Podía correr rápido.* (I was able to run fast.) |

| ****Preterite (*pude*)**** | Specific success/failure | *Pude correr la maratón.* (I managed to run the marathon.) |

◆ ****Regular Forms**** :

- Past Participle: *podido*

- Imperfect: *podía, podías, podía...*

 ****Common Structures with "Poder"**:**

| Structure | Meaning | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| *poder + infinitive* | to be able to do something | *Puedo hablar español.* |

| *¿Puedo...?* | May I...? / Can I...? | *¿Puedo entrar?* |

| *no poder más* | to be unable to take more | *No puedo más de cansancio.* |

| *poder con algo* | to cope with something | *No puedo con esta caja.* |

 ****Poder vs. Saber**:**

| Verb | Meaning | Example |

|-----|-----|-----|

| *Poder* | Physical ability / possibility | *Puedo levantar esto.* (I can lift this.) |

| *Saber* | Knowledge / learned skill | *Sé nadar.* (I know how to swim.) |

💡 ****Pro Tip****:

Poder is often used to make polite requests:

- *¿Podría pasarme la sal?* (Could you pass me the salt?)

- *¿Puedes ayudarme?* (Can you help me?)

✅ ****Ready for the next verb!**** Just say: ***"Next verb: [verb]"*** 🚀